

SNAKEBYTE

Game design document



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Overview

Working title: Snackrifice

Elevator pitch: Don't let your precious offerings get away! In Snackrifice you play as a giant serpent god which gets human sacrifices from his devote followers. Dash into the fleeting sacrifices don't let them escape your domain.

Short description: A spin on the original snake game, Snackrifice is a top-down 2D arcade game where you control a giant snake that tries to catch his human sacrifices. As your regular movement speed is too slow to catch up with your prey, you will have to aim yourself and charge into their direction in order to catch up. Try to get the highest score and keep up as more sacrifices are being thrown into your domain.

Genre(s):

- Action
- Casual
- Indie

Similar games (Core mechanic): Slither.IO, SNKRX

Target audience:

- Casual players
- **Age** group of 8+
- By **Bartle's taxonomy of player types** this game will mainly attract **Achievers player types.**
- By Newzoo's gamer persona, the game could appeal most to:
    - The time filler
    - The all-around enthusiast

Platforms: Release version PC. Android and consoles are also considered for later installations.

Gameplay

Goal(s)

The goal of the game is to not let any of the targets that are trying to escape to go off screen and try to reach the highest score you can.

Original design pillars

- Simple controls, hard to master
- Overwhelming Fast paced decision-making gameplay. Should put the players in tight spots that the player needs to react fast and appropriately to survive.
- Players' actions have a negative reaction. All actions in the game feed into the challenge itself.

Mechanics

Core mechanic

Snake moves towards the mouse and dashes when players press the left click button on the mouse. During a dash the snake moves faster but it cannot rotate.

System(s)

Character

- Movement (PC build)
    - In the game you control a snake the follows the movement of your mouse. The head of the snake will try to get to the position of the mouse and the other body parts follow the path that the head has taken.
    - The snake has 2 states of movement
        - During the regular state, the snake follows the mouse consistentlry, with decent speed and good turning speed. This state is the slower more controllable state and should let the feel comfroble moving and aiming the snake's head which is important for the second state.



        - During the dash state, the snake cannot rotate but his movement speed is greatly increased in the direction the head was aiming at when the dash was triggered. The dash only lasts for a short time to let players have more control over the use of it and mistake mistakes if they make one. The dash in this game was designed to make the snake almost reach one edge of the screen to another in order to help it reach far off targets (Explained later).

Visually the snake turns red during it's dash to indicate to the player at which state it's currently in. Dashing also includes a swift sound effect to sell the idea of the speed of the snake.



- The movement between these 2 states is instantaneous when triggered but there is a sequence of actions that is favored for the game. The player needs to move fast between the 2 states to get the best of them, regular state giving control and dashing giving speed. If you never use the dash, you won't be fast enough to get to the fleeting targets (explained later) and only dashing will set the snake to flying with no aim. The right sequence that should be is dashing towards your target, letting the snake position itself correctly and dashing again in fast succession.
  - How spamming dash looks like



- The snake cannot move out of the bounds of the level

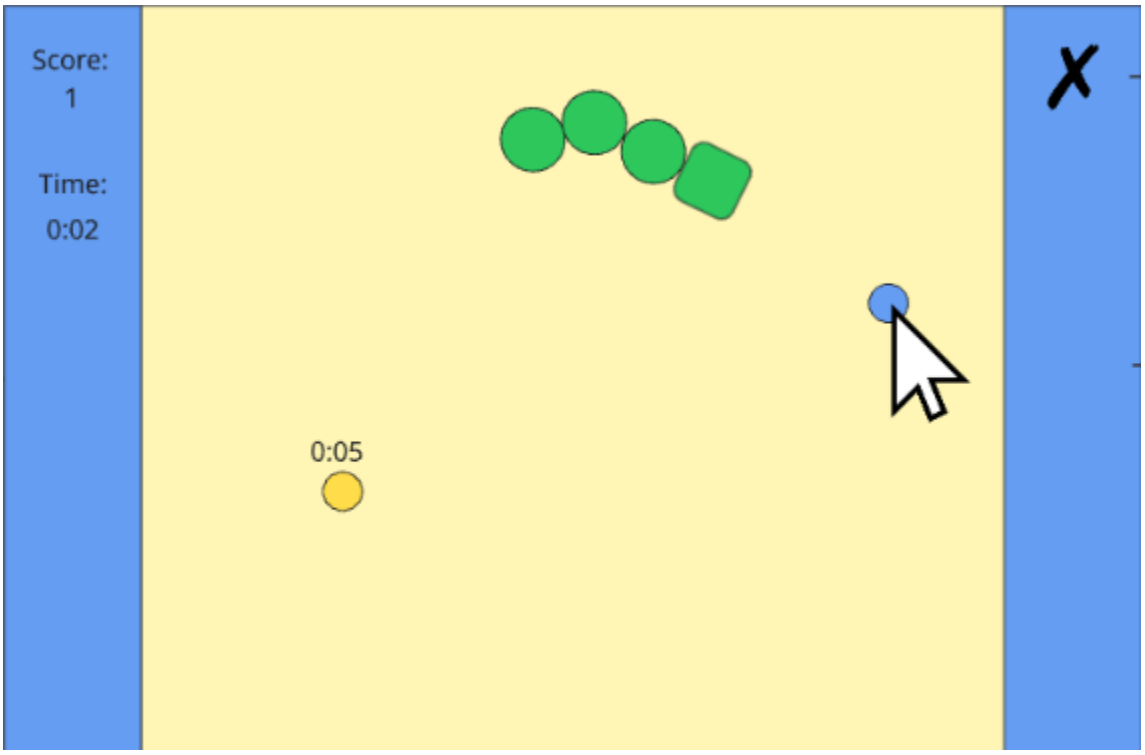


- Eating (with connection to targets that will be explained later)
  - Eating a target in the game adds another body part at the end of the snake
    - Eating a target during the regular state gives a bite sound effect, a small screen shake and leaves a small puddle to let the player know they eat an enemy.
    - Eating a target during a dash will play the bite sfx along with a harder screen shake, a flash effect in the background and will leave a big puddle with debris flying out of the target. This is both to sell the impact of the dash and to reward players for using the dash as I want them to consistently use it.



Camera

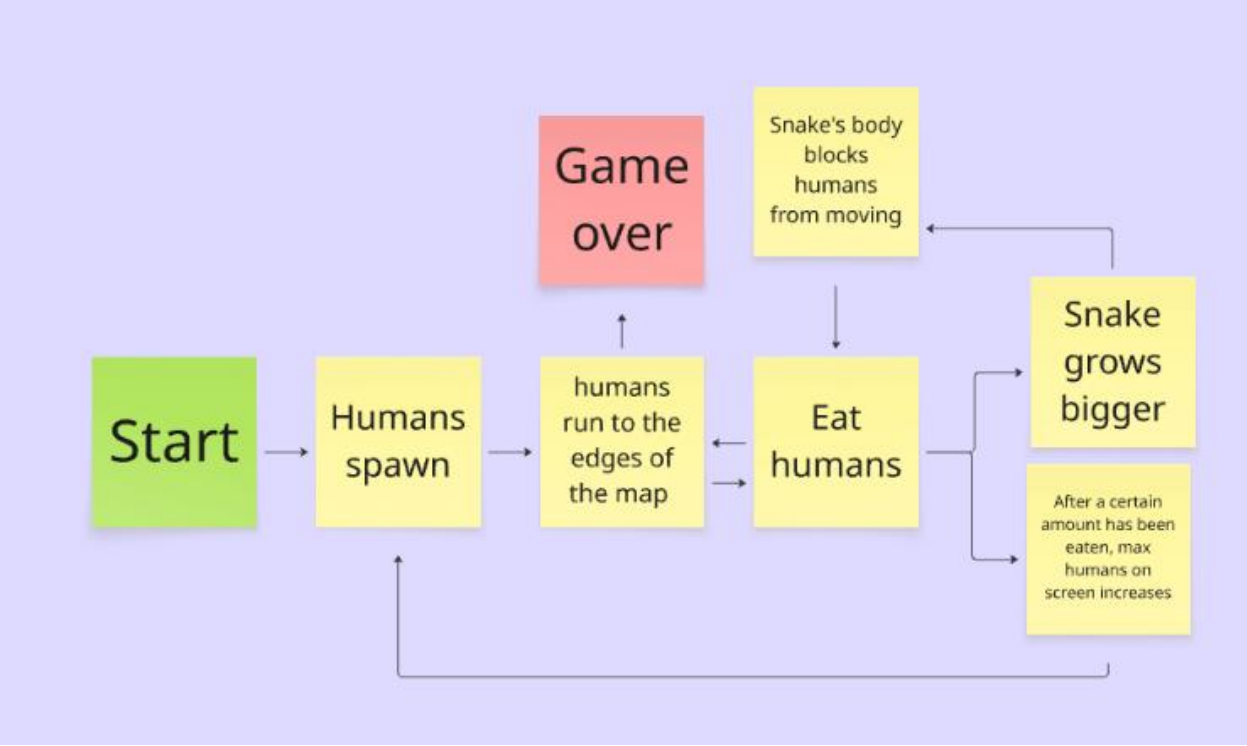
- The camera has a static 2D top-down look, and it shows the entire level all at once. Showing the entire level ensures that the player has constant view and knowledge of information.
- A little bit of space is left on the sides of the screen to give space to the score board and other buttons that are necessary without obscuring the screen for the player.



Other systems

- Enemies/ Targets
    - The enemies randomly spawn from the center of the map and try to go to the edges in order to escape. If any of them manage to escape the camera should focus on them and the game over screen will display, showing you your score.
    - Enemies start spawning in groups of 2 and as the players eats more, the number that spawns each time will go up. Set now to be every 10 enemies eaten.
    - The snake can use it's body to block enemies path, forcing them to try and find a different rout to escape from.
- Scoreboard
    - A scoreboard is presented in all screens and a high score is shown at the end and start screens to set a goal to the player in every playthrough of the game.

Core game loop



Planned screen flowchart

